Brandon: Green Flag / Red Flag - Full Series

What to actually look for. Brandon calls each signal green flag or red flag. Open on the first item. Grouped by theme.

JOB & CAREER

A Job Offer

- Pay way above market for the role
- Rushed you, wants an answer tomorrow
- Can clearly explain how you'll be measured
- Role "created just for you"
- Everyone you'd work with seems checked out
- The person who'd manage you is impressive

The Interview

- Can't tell you why the last person left
- The owner interviews you personally
- Ghosts you two weeks, then rushes
- Asks about results, not years of experience
- Three rounds for an entry-level job
- Keeps selling "we're like a family"

Your Boss

- Takes credit for your work
- Still does the hardest jobs themselves
- Only gives feedback at review time
- Protects their people from above
- Changes direction every week
- Hires people smarter than themselves

A Company Worth Working For

- Growing and hiring
- Constant reorgs and layoffs
- Owner reinvests instead of flashing money
- High turnover on your future team
- Quietly profitable for years, no hype
- Everyone's title is inflated

A Job Candidate (hiring side)

- Job-hopped every year
- Runs a side hustle
- Asks great questions about the role
- Overqualified, "just needs something"
- Followed up without being told to
- Bad-mouths their last employer

MONEY & INVESTING

Your Personal Finances

- Car payment bigger than your rent
- No emergency fund but you're investing
- Multiple buy-now-pay-later balances
- You know your monthly number cold
- Raise came and spending rose to match
- Never checked your credit score

An Investment Opportunity

- "Guaranteed" returns
- They can't explain how it makes money
- Pressure to decide today
- Everyone you know is already in
- You can see exactly where the money goes
- The seller has their own money in it

BUSINESS & DEALS

Your Business Partner

- Puts in money but no work
- Wants 50/50 (someone must be in charge)
- Family or best friend
- Great at sales, terrible with details
- Never risked their own money
- Disappears when it gets hard

A Business to Buy

- Owner is desperate to leave
- One customer is half the revenue
- Only works because owner works 80 hrs
- Been around 30 years
- Books are a mess
- Recurring revenue you can count on

A Client

- Haggles on price before you start
- Pays the deposit without being chased
- "This'll be great exposure"
- Respects your time
- Wants everything in writing
- Already fired their last three vendors

Your Business Idea

- A logo but no customers
- Someone already tried to pay you for it
- Only works if you're the one doing it
- You'd do it even if it stayed small
- Solves a problem you personally had
- The whole plan depends on going viral

"I'm an Entrepreneur"

- Talks more about lifestyle than the work
- Reinvests instead of flexing
- Three "businesses," none profitable
- Knows their numbers off the top of their head
- Always launching, never shipping
- Started small and boring

REAL ESTATE

Your Commercial Broker

- Tells you to lower your price on day one
- Never picks up on weekends
- Shows you properties above your budget
- Does this part-time
- Represents both buyer and seller
- Won your listing by quoting the highest price

A Real Estate Deal (investor)

- Seller is suddenly desperate to close
- Rents are below market (upside)
- One tenant is most of the income
- Seller offers to finance it
- Deferred maintenance everywhere
- Numbers only work if everything goes right

A Rental Property

- Cash flows on day one
- "It'll appreciate" is the whole thesis
- Great school district
- Needs a full renovation to rent
- The HOA runs the place
- Long-term tenant already in place